

# SWITZERLAND

Switzerland – Key Country Details Table

| Detail                    | Information                                                                                                                                          |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Full Name</b>          | Swiss Confederation                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Short Form</b>         | Switzerland                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Capital</b>            | Bern (de facto); note: Switzerland has no official capital, but Bern is the federal city where the government is based                               |
| <b>Region (UN)</b>        | Western European and Others Group (WEOG)                                                                                                             |
| <b>Government Type</b>    | Federal semi-direct democracy under a multi-party parliamentary system                                                                               |
| <b>Head of State</b>      | Viola Amherd (President of the Swiss Confederation, 2025)                                                                                            |
| <b>Head of Government</b> | The Swiss Federal Council (collective head of government; Viola Amherd is President in 2025)                                                         |
| <b>Currency</b>           | Swiss Franc (CHF)                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>UN Member Since</b>    | 10 September 2002                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>MUN Standing</b>       | Neutral country with strong humanitarian influence; key actor in diplomacy, peace negotiations, human rights, and host to many UN agencies in Geneva |

## Recommended Books on Switzerland's Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

1. "Swiss Foreign Policy: Foundations and Future" –
2. "Neutrality and the European Union: The Case of Switzerland" –
3. "Switzerland and the United Nations: A Close Relationship" –
4. "The Swiss Confederation: A Brief Guide" –
5. "Switzerland's Role in International Organizations" –

# Switzerland & UNCSW: Verified Resource Table

## Switzerland & UNCSW: Verified Resource Table

| Source Name                                                           | Link                                                                                                                                                    | Why It's Useful                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Swiss National Council – Gender Equality</b>                       | <a href="https://www.parlament.ch/en/organe/national-council">https://www.parlament.ch/en/organe/national-council</a>                                   | Parliamentary work and legislation related to gender equality and women's rights.                 |
| <b>Swiss Federal Office for Gender Equality (FOGE)</b>                | <a href="https://www.ebg.admin.ch/ebg/en/home.html">https://www.ebg.admin.ch/ebg/en/home.html</a>                                                       | Switzerland's government agency responsible for promoting equality between women and men.         |
| <b>Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation – Gender Equality</b> | <a href="https://www.sdc.admin.ch/sdc/en/home/themes-sdc/gender-equality.html">https://www.sdc.admin.ch/sdc/en/home/themes-sdc/gender-equality.html</a> | Development projects and programs supported by Switzerland focusing on gender equality worldwide. |
| <b>Swiss Parliament – Women in Politics</b>                           | <a href="https://www.parlament.ch/en/ratsmitglieder">https://www.parlament.ch/en/ratsmitglieder</a>                                                     | Data and reports on women's representation in the Swiss parliament.                               |
| <b>Switzerland's Gender Equality Reports to the UN</b>                | <a href="https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/1681336?ln=en">https://digitallibrary.un.org/record/1681336?ln=en</a>                                     | Switzerland's official reports submitted to the UN on progress in gender equality.                |

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|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Swiss Federal Council Gender Equality Initiatives PDF</b> | <a href="https://www.admin.ch/opc/en/classified-compilation/19950171/index.html">https://www.admin.ch/opc/en/classified-compilation/19950171/index.html</a> | Official legal texts and initiatives to promote gender equality in Switzerland. |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

| Source Name                                                     | Link                                                                                                                                                    | Why It's Useful                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Swiss Development Cooperation – Gender Equality Projects</b> | <a href="https://www.sdc.admin.ch/sdc/en/home/themes-sdc/gender-equality.html">https://www.sdc.admin.ch/sdc/en/home/themes-sdc/gender-equality.html</a> | Updated info on Swiss-funded gender equality projects worldwide, aligned with UNCSW goals.     |
| <b>UN Women Global Database – Switzerland Profile</b>           | <a href="https://data.unwomen.org/country/switzerland">https://data.unwomen.org/country/switzerland</a>                                                 | Data and country-specific insights into Switzerland's contributions to global gender equality. |

## Unique Aspects of Switzerland's UNCSW Engagement and Gender Agenda

- **Pioneering Gender Equality Laws:** Switzerland stands out in Europe for its forward-thinking laws on gender equality, featuring impressive parental leave policies and measures aimed at wage transparency.
- **Neutral Country with Active UN Role:** As the home to numerous UN agencies, Geneva plays a crucial diplomatic role in influencing discussions at the UN Commission on the Status of Women (UNCSW) on a global scale.
- **Strong Focus on Economic Gender Equality:** Switzerland is really focused on narrowing the gender pay gap and increasing the number of women in leadership roles and innovative fields.
- **Integration of Gender Equality in Foreign Aid:** The Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation is committed to integrating gender equality into

all its international cooperation projects, positioning Switzerland as a leading donor for women's empowerment around the world.

- **Robust Data-Driven Gender Policies:** The Federal Statistical Office offers a wealth of clear and detailed gender-disaggregated data, which is essential for making informed policy decisions.

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